PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

Prepared By: Remsha Imtiaz
Student ID : **CA/DF1//33484**
Website : **CODE ALPHA**
Domain : **Cyber Security**

Contents

- Introduction to Phishing
- Importance and Risks of Phishing
- Types of Phishing Attacks
- Identifying Phishing Emails
- Detecting Fake Websites
- Social Engineering Techniques
- Real-World Case Study
- Preventive Measures and Best Practices
- Technical Security Controls
- Response to Phishing Attacks
- Interactive Quiz
- Conclusion
- References

INTRODUCTION

Phishing is a type of **cyber attack** where attackers impersonate legitimate entities to steal sensitive data such as:

- Usernames and passwords
- Banking details
- Personal information

It is one of the most common forms of cybercrime due to its **low cost and high success rate**.

Why Phishing is Dangerous

- Can lead to **financial loss**
- Causes **identity theft**
- Compromises **organizational data security**
- Can result in **unauthorized system access**

According to cybersecurity reports, phishing accounts for **over 80% of security incidents**.

Types of Phishing Attacks

- **Email Phishing** – Mass emails sent to many users
- **Spear Phishing** – Targeted attack on specific individuals
- **Smishing** – Phishing through SMS messages
- **Vishing** – Voice-based phishing via phone calls

Email Phishing – Key Characteristics

Phishing emails often contain:

- Fake sender addresses (e.g., support@bank-secure.com)
- Urgent messages (e.g., “Your account will be blocked”)
- Suspicious links
- Attachments containing malware

How to Recognize Phishing Emails

Look for the following indicators:

- **Mismatch in email address and sender name**
- Poor grammar and spelling errors
- Unusual or urgent requests
- Links that redirect to unknown websites
- Unexpected attachments

Engineering analogy:
Just like a **hairline crack indicates structural failure**, small email inconsistencies indicate a phishing attempt.

Identifying Fake Websites

Fake websites are designed to look identical to real ones.

Key Signs:

- URL mismatch (e.g.www.paypa1.com instead of www.paypal.com)
- Absence of HTTPS (no 🔒 symbol)
- Poor interface design
- Requests for sensitive information

Social Engineering Tactics

Phishing relies on **human psychology**, not technical hacking.
Common Techniques:

- **Urgency** → “Act immediately!”
- **Fear** → “Your account will be suspended”
- **Authority** → Pretending to be a manager or bank
- **Curiosity** → “You won a prize!”

This is manipulation of **human decision-making behavior**.

Real-World Example (Case Study)

A user receives an email claiming to be from a bank:

- Message asks to “verify account details”
- User clicks link → enters credentials
- Attacker gains access → withdraws money

Result:

- Financial loss
- Account compromise

Best Practices to Avoid Phishing

- Do not click unknown links
- Always verify sender identity
- Use strong, unique passwords
- Enable **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)**
- Never share OTPs or passwords

Technical Preventive Measures

- Install antivirus and firewall systems
- Keep software updated
- Use email spam filters
- Implement organizational cybersecurity policies

What to Do If You Suspect Phishing

- Do not click links or download attachments
- Report the email to IT/admin
- Delete the email immediately
- Change passwords if credentials were entered

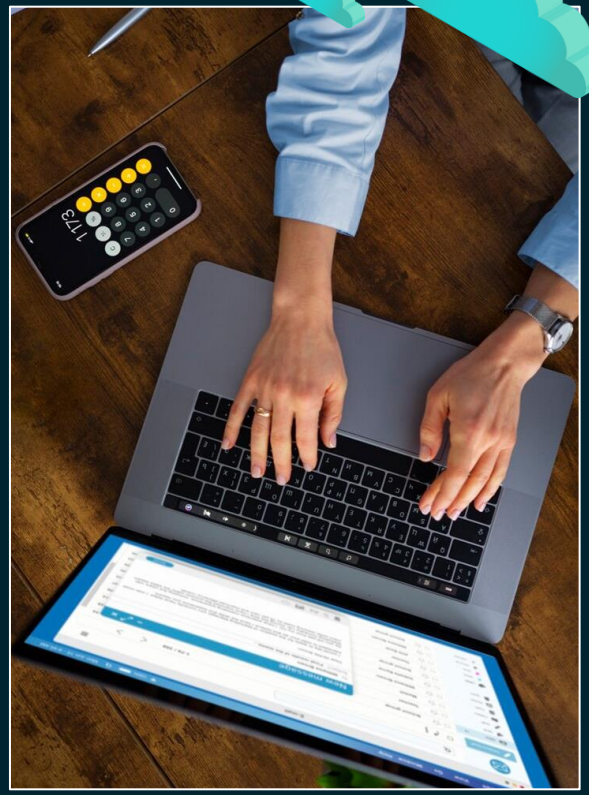
Interactive Quiz

Q1: Which is a sign of phishing?

A. Secure HTTPS website
B. Unknown sender email ✅
C. Verified domain

Q2: What should you do if you receive a suspicious email?

A. Click the link
B. Reply immediately
C. Report and delete ✅



Conclusion

- Phishing is a **serious cybersecurity threat**
- Awareness is the **first line of defense**
- Always verify before trusting any digital communication

Final Thought:
Think before you click — security starts with you.

References

- Cybersecurity & Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA)
- Kaspersky Cybersecurity Reports
- Norton Security Guidelines
- OWASP Security Practices